suppose that was why I never had any of my own.

If there is still some tiny part of you that hopes we might reunite, come to Berlin. I don't think we'll have another chance.

Please, if you won't come for me, then come for Katya and Eve. I have something for them.

You might need to forget the past, but your daughters likely want to know more, and we're the only ones who can tell them.

With all my love,

Rose

* * *

Léa's woolen scarf flew around her face in the bitter wind as she walked along Unter den Linden in East Berlin. She looked up at the bare-branched linden trees, unable to remember them being there. Maybe they'd been planted after the war. Beyond, the sky was gray and threatening rain. Despite the weather, people were out on the streets. Many had come from the West, like Léa and her daughters, crossing over for the day to take photos and point at the bullet holes left in the buildings from the war.

On the day she'd been released from the displaced persons camp near Prina and put on an American army cargo truck for the five-day trip to the repatriation center at the Gare d'Orsay in Paris, she'd sworn she would never step foot in Germany again. But now here she was in Berlin.

"Maman, what could she have for us?" Katya's arm looped through her mother's, holding her close.

"I don't know." Léa's voice was weary. She hadn't slept all night. She kept tossing and turning, wondering what she would say to Rose. It was all so long ago. A part of her just wanted to leave it in the past. And yet, underneath her anxiety, she longed to see her little sister again.

Up ahead, recognizing the side street where the Kaffee Post had been, she stopped, unsure she could do this.

"Shall we sit on a bench?" Eve pointed to a spot across the street. "And give you a moment?"

They crossed the street and settled on the bench; the rigid wooden slats dug into Léa's back.

"Maybe she won't recognize me and I won't recognize her," Léa said. It